

Interviewer: Yes, welcome again, good evening. Thank you again for participating in this interview. As we mentioned in the message we sent, we want to learn more about your views on romantic relationships, and we believe that your experiences and views will greatly contribute to our project. Before we start, I would like to ask again if it is okay to record this interview. We will use it for transcription and note-taking purposes. Is it okay with you?

Speaker: Sure

Interviewer: How old are you, [Participant's Name]?

Speaker: [31-35].

Interviewer: How long have you been with your partner?

Speaker: Umm... [6-10] years, [6-10] years. [6-10], and [1-5] engagement year, [6-10] years.

Interviewer: Do you have children?

Speaker: Yes, I have [1-5] children.

Interviewer: Who do you live with at home?

Speaker: Me, my spouse, children, and my mother.

Interviewer: What are your main sources of income and your current job?

Speaker: Both my spouse and I are [occupation]; we have salaries. Besides that, we bought a house. Although it is not rented now, we get rental income from it. So we are in peace.

Interviewer: How would you like me to address your partner? Girlfriend, wife, lover, what do you prefer?

Speaker: Me or you? I did not understand.

Interviewer: What would you prefer? Umm, I can call her your wife. I can call to her as your lover.

Speaker: You can say wife. She is my wife, wife.

Interviewer: Alright. Can you tell me about how you met your wife and how your relationship started?

Speaker: Umm, my wife started working at the [location] in [Year]. I started in [Year]. In [Year], I used to see her in the corridors and say hello. There wasn't much intimacy. In [Year], sorry, in [Year], we were assigned to the same office, a [department] office. There we made eye contact and such. There was an interaction. That's how I got interested in my wife. Thanks to a close brother of mine (note: In Turkish, brother is also called an older close friend), I told him about the situation and asked for his help. He, in turn, approached a close sister of her (note: His wife's friend), explaining the situation and he said let's make them meet. After that, we met. It was a bit quick; we got married [1-5] year later.

Interviewer: How did your relationship develop? Could you elaborate a bit more on that part?

Speaker: You mean the falling in love part, right?

Interviewer: Actually, whichever part you want to share, but I would like to know a bit more about how it developed.

Speaker: So, initially, it was just saying hello. There wasn't much intimacy; I didn't know her. We were assigned to the same office. You know, everyone has a dream partner. For women, there might be a prince charming; for men, a Cinderella. I want the woman I marry to be like this, to be like that, and so on. I envisioned her to be like this, to be like that, but not in terms of physical appearance; I was more focused on her personality traits. When we started working together, she had all those traits I dreamed of. She was mature, well-spoken, smiled appropriately. That's where the interaction began. Our offices were opposite each other in the same office, so I would

go to their room with unrelated excuses many times just to see my partner again and to be sure. After that, as I said, I think I entered the phase of falling in love. Because I constantly wanted to see her. So, after that, I sent a message through my friend. I mean, I asked for his help because I couldn't do it alone. I couldn't face her. Thankfully, she didn't refuse, and we had lunch together. After that, we started talking. We talked what we want and don't want, what could work and what couldn't. Then, we realized we were compatible. That's how we started seeing each other. It was nice, it was good.

Interviewer: How would you compare your relationship to those of your friends?

Speaker: From my perspective, it's very good. But my wife says it's not. We even went to a psychologist a few times. In our courthouse, there is a duty roster. I stayed on duty a bit too much. To have extra income, I somewhat neglected my family. It seemed like my job had become more important. We struggled a bit during that period. Then my daughter was born. After that, I stopped taking extra duties. I would go to work with my wife and come back home with her. So my wife was very much like, for example 'Look, [Name] and [Name], our friends, went on a vacation there. They did this for their spouses. You did this for me. Their spouse did this. You don't do this,' and so on. This still continues. We had a lot of problems with this at one point. When I think about it, compared to my friends' relationships, I can say there are better aspects and worse aspects in mine.

Interviewer: Could you elaborate on why you think your relationship is better in some aspects and worse in others?

Speaker: For example, we are government employees. We cannot have side jobs. We only have to rely on our salary. We cannot do extra work. For instance, my wife and I save our salaries, thinking of it as a single income. We spend it like this - my wife usually restrains me because I tend to shop a lot. For example, we bought a house, and we are currently paying off the installments. God willing, we will buy a car in [Month]. If I were single, I'm sure none of this would have happened. My wife supports me a lot in this regard. I have many cousins, [41-45] years old or even older, who still have a lot of debt. Financially, my wife keeps me in check. She has a good sense of spending wisely. So, that's good. What's bad? The bad parts are bad... For example, my friends are more relaxed. I can't be that relaxed. My wife generally gets moody about these things. For instance, if I say I'm going somewhere and she says I can't go, she doesn't want me to go. If I do go, she gives me the silent treatment for 1-2-3 days. Or, she gets upset with me for even the simplest mistake. That's what I'd say is the downside.

Interviewer: How many romantic relationships have you had in the past?

Speaker: [1-5] or [1-5], let's say [1-5].

Interviewer: how would you compare the quality of your relationship compared to your previous relationships?

Speaker: My current relationship is better. The first one was in 3rd grade. I still can't forget it. You could call it a childhood crush. One was at the beginning of my civil service, about [10-15] years ago, when I was single and we dated. It's not that I couldn't forget, but we couldn't get along and parted ways amicably. When I think about all [1-5] now, I would still marry my wife. Whether it's because I've gotten used to it, I don't know.

Interviewer: Would you like to elaborate on why you said that?

Speaker: I probably love my wife, that's why. Especially since we've been married for [1-5] years, I've gotten used to it. There's this saying for us men, "Behind every successful man,

there's a woman." I think my wife is the one behind me. It's either my mother or my wife. We men are like something, aren't we? They always say, "We have a small memory. We work with instructions." If my wife had given me bad instructions, like "let's do this, let's do that, let's travel here, let's travel there," it would have been bad both financially and spiritually. So, she's good in that regard. That's why it's my wife.

Interviewer: What makes a high-quality relationship for you?

Speaker: Firstly respect. Then, love (note: Sevgi), and loyalty. These three are essential. Without them, the rest doesn't matter. When you have these three, the rest follows.

Interviewer: Why did you say these three? Would you like to elaborate these concepts?

Speaker: For example, what I mean by love. I mean, if I were forced to marry someone who doesn't love me, due to family pressure or something from her family. I married that girl, but she doesn't love me, her heart belongs to someone else. Even if she lives with me for years, her heart is not with me. You certainly can't take pleasure from those eyes, those looks. Looking into the eyes of your spouse, you constantly have problems with someone you love. Loyalty, already, you know. The matter of cheating. The other thing is respect. We are all human; we can make mistakes. I'll be very simple. For example, as an example, I mean. The glass fell to the ground. If my spouse reacted like, "What are you doing, idiot? You dropped the glass," it wouldn't be a That's why I say spouses shouldn't hurt each other. Hurtful words shouldn't be there. Something like that is needed. Something in that style.

Interviewer: What makes a low-quality relationship for you?

Speaker: Low... We can say disrespect. Disorder. And the most important thing is that spouses do not understand each other. Like this: when people with different ways of thinking/mindsets get married, I can say.

Interviewer: Yes. Actually, I will ask similar questions again. I would be very happy if you could elaborate a bit more on why you think this way.

Speaker: Well, for example, now my spouse has X thoughts. I have Y thoughts. They should not come together. If they are opposing thoughts, we can never agree. Even if we agree today, tomorrow or the day after, or when we face a problem, she will come up with a different solution, and I will come up with a different one. Then we will insist, "Oh, you said this, I said that," and there will be a problem. That's why I said thoughts should align. Other than that... that's all.

Interviewer: So then, can you say that, for you, high-quality relationships are those with high levels of respect?

Speaker: Yes, definitely, definitely.

Interviewer: So, how can a person understand that they are in such a relationship? Could you give us a bit more information about this?

Speaker: Do you mean for myself or for someone else?

Interviewer: I mean, actually, how do you think about this personally? I don't want to guide you too much. How do you think a person can realize that they are in such a relationship? That's what I'm asking about, actually.

Speaker: Understood. I'll answer by thinking about myself. So, back when my spouse and I were dating, we hadn't even known each other for long. I faced some financial problems, and she supported me. She said, "You can do it, everyone makes mistakes." She talked about coming together for this reason, and she did things like that. She supported me in that regard. I made a mistake. Yes, she could have said, "You made a mistake, you did this and that." But

she didn't. She supported me. And she continues to support me constantly. Even after we got married, she still does. So, that's why I say respect isn't just about helping, but also about kind words or support, and most importantly, for us men, it's about being supportive. And like I said, those looks. The loving glances, I mean. When I look at my spouse, I should feel happy, so that I can say, "Yes, this is happiness, there's a beautiful relationship here."

Interviewer: So, when would you say your relationship exhibited these qualities more? When you look at your own relationship, from the beginning until now, when do you think these qualities were more present and when were they less so?

Speaker: We got engaged with my spouse, that's when it started. Before that, as I mentioned, because of these qualities, there was a kind of love—like falling in love. We got engaged. It continued from there. Like I said, after we got married, for example, my spouse said something to me. She said, "When you were single, you used to take care of yourself more, do this, do that. You paid attention to your attire. Now you've relaxed a lot, done this and that." And like I said, because my spouse was working a lot with more important matters, we had some issues during that period. After resolving those issues, we're good now. So, it's been ups and downs, but as I said, when there's respect, problems get solved.

Interviewer: If it's alright with you, actually, you touched on these in your previous answers a bit. I just want to ask again. What are the most important things for you in a relationship?

Speaker: If it's alright with you, actually, you touched on these in your previous answers a bit. I just want to ask again. What are the most important things for you in a relationship?

Interviewer: Actually, I'm going to ask a similar question again. I'll kindly request you to elaborate a bit more on these. If you'd like to explain why you said that.

Speaker: Nowadays, couples are just... Look, her eyes are very beautiful, I should marry this girl. Or there are couples who say, 'He's a very handsome guy, I should marry him,' and they get married. Or there are couples who start dating. And there are those who are only influenced by external appearance and want to meet, who face problems. Actually, the external surface is just skin and bone. It's the same for everyone. It's just the shapes of people's faces that are different. But nowadays, of course, beauty seems more important. People don't look at the heart. Okay, the right eye is a bit lower, this is ugly. But maybe someone who doesn't look good superficially might be very attached to you. They might be a couple who will make you the happiest person in the world. But whether it's because of appearance or a thought, it affects a lot. There's no respect. Or there's a lot of lying. For example, 'I do this job. I do that.' You start dating. They do the exact opposite of what they said. Maybe they're a scammer or something. That's why it's like that.

Interviewer: What does love mean to you?

Speaker: Love is when your heart skips a beat when you see the person.

Interviewer: Can you give an example?

Speaker: Speaker: Love? It's when your heart trembles as your eyes meet.

Interviewer: Could you give us a bit more of an example of when your heart trembles as your eyes meet?

Speaker: Let me give you an example from my own life, if you don't mind. Like I said, I started working in the same office with my spouse. Initially, it was just casual greetings. I didn't have that intimacy or those thoughts at all. She just sat next to me. Not next to me, actually, she sat across from me a little further away. She looked at me. It was like something completely

different happened, you know? My mind immediately wandered off. It's like when the officiant asks, "Do you take this person to be your lawful wedded spouse?" You stand up and celebrate. Your mind just goes there immediately. "What an amazing woman," you think. She just looked at me. I mean, I said I'm doing this thing. You know, like, what are you thinking about your friends, I asked. But apparently, I was in love. That's how I see it.

Interviewer: So, how important is love for you in a relationship?

Speaker: I couldn't hear that. Could you repeat it?

Interviewer: Of course, sorry. How important is love for you in a relationship?

Speaker: I would say more than half of the cake slice. I might even say 75%.

Interviewer: I see. What else is in the rest of this cake slice? Would you like to talk about those?

Speaker: Like I said, respect, love, understanding, support. These could be some.

Interviewer: I see. You've mentioned the great importance of love in general. How do you know if your partner loves you?

Speaker: For example, I really love potato fries. And my spouse doesn't like them at all.

Interviewer: I didn't catch what dish you mentioned.

Speaker: Potato fries.

Interviewer: Ah, I see. Sorry.

Speaker: I'm speaking a bit fast, sorry about that. I really love it. Like, I could eat it all day long. You might say, "Are we going to eat this every day?" But I'm not like that; I could eat it 24/7. And my spouse hates it. When I come home, for example, my spouse cooks a meal according to her own taste. Additionally, She makes that dish just because she know I love it

Interviewer: I see.

Speaker: I mean, isn't that love? Making a dish you don't like, with care and attention. Not just bungling up.

Interviewer: I see. So... I mean, in this case, making these fries for you, what other aspects could you use to describe it? Because you mentioned care, because they make it with care. Are there other aspects you could mention here? How you understand she loves you, like saying it's this way, or that way, for example. Because you gave a great example, but I'd like to hear more about it.

Speaker: I understand. Well, for instance, like I said, she makes sacrifices for you. They meticulously prepare a dish she doesn't like, wondering if I would like it. Secondly, there was a time I spent too much on my credit card. A hefty bill came. I told my spouse, explained the situation, said I couldn't pay it off. "Don't worry, we'll handle it," she said. "That's why we're married," she said. And she supported me with that debt. They backed me up. And we've managed it now. I don't think someone would support someone she doesn't love like that.

Interviewer: I see.

Speaker: Also, last year, during an earthquake, for instance, I volunteered in Adiyaman for ten days. When I came back, my spouse had prepared my favorite meals. I guess that's what love is like. If she didn't love me, she could've said, "Oh, it's you," dismissively. Or treated me like it's just another regular day. But she didn't do that; she missed me quite a bit. We were apart for ten days, but she missed me a lot.

Interviewer: So, could you tell us about the difficulties in your relationship with your spouse?

Speaker: Like I said, we've had ups and downs. We even considered divorce at one point. Um... My spouse... -especially my mother, who lives with us to look after the child-. Our kids are

young, and we both work. She called me stupid in front of my mother. "Why did you do that? Why are you so stupid?" She made belittling remarks like that. She still does it occasionally. It creates a rift. Or like I said, for example... that credit card debt I mentioned earlier. Um, from another debt. "Why did you do this? Why did you spend so much?" But actually, I brought things for home as well, I didn't just buy something for myself. I bought something for the kids too. And she was like "you've created this debt, you have to pay it off", she's turning that into a reversal. It's like this... We sometimes face problems, especially during rough times.

Interviewer: Do you and your spouse fight?

Speaker: I'm sorry?

Interviewer: Do you and your spouse fight?

Speaker: Yes, unfortunately, occasionally.

Interviewer: How often does this happen? How often would you say these arguments occur?

Speaker: Well, about [] times a month, definitely. I mean, it's not intense fights, not loud. It's more like a verbal altercation. My wife gets angry at me, goes to the bedroom. I ignore her for an hour. I tell her I'm not going to talk to her. I go out for a walk. It's always like that for me. Um... I have a bit of hyperactivity, a hyperactivity issue. So sometimes I go out for a walk to calm down. Then I go back to my wife. We make up after teasing (Anil's note: in a good/fun way) each other.

Interviewer: What are these arguments usually about?

Speaker: Well, usually it's because of me, I think. She thinks it's because of me. But like I said, for example, insulting me in front of my mother. I got mad at her for that. "It was like this, it was like that", and we had a little fall out there. Or, um, something else. Like not sitting next to her while eating. Today, before this meeting, an hour ago, our problem was this. I wasn't hungry, she had cooked. Why didn't you sit next to me at the table? Why didn't you sit next to me? She got angry at me. Um... Right now. Are we okay now? Yes, we are okay now.

Interviewer: How do you resolve these arguments? How do you make up?

Speaker: Actually, I've learned something. I've been married for [1-5] years. We've had quite a few fights. We argue about once or twice a month, for sure. I've learned this. If spouses say, without hurting each other, "my issue is this. You do this and this, and it bothers me," the problem would be solved. But for us... Let me say this for our country. They expect the other side to understand the problem. The other side made a mistake. They should understand without saying it. They don't understand. Tell it then. No, they'll understand and solve the problem. My wife has this problem a lot. She says, "You think. Think you made a mistake." Or, um, in a sulky way, "You know what you did." What did I do? There's actually a very simple explanation. But she doesn't listen. She tells me to explain it to her. But since I don't understand what she's implying, I can't explain it to her. And we have these problems. Like I said, without hurting each other, if you say, "you have this problem," the problem would be solved. It's a very small problem. But like I said. If you're going to sulk at me, "I'm going to do this to you". "If you're going to do this to me, I'm going to do this"... By mutually saying these things, then a tiny problem goes away like a mountain.

Interviewer: Actually, you mentioned that the solution in any conflict can be through communication and without hurting each other. What are other ways to sustain a relationship besides these?

Speaker: I think it's important to be financially stable. Because, you know, if you're facing financial issues, like if I had financial problems, my mind would constantly be on money, money, money. I wouldn't be able to give attention to my spouse. I wouldn't be able to spend time with the kids. Or I wouldn't be able to do something they want. And for my spouse, -in the opposite— if she had financial issues, her mind would be occupied there, and she wouldn't be able to give us attention. So financially, we could say that's why. Other... I can't think of any right now, since you asked directly. I'm not prepared at all.

Interviewer: I see, they're not easy questions. I understand that. People can't always be prepared. But, you know. We can wait. Or we can move on from the question. How would you prefer?

Speaker: Okay, let's continue then, let's move on to the next question.

Interviewer: Can you say that this relationship is good for you?

Speaker: Yes, it's very good for me.

Interviewer: Why is that?

Speaker: My life has fallen into place. I have a spouse who supports me besides my mother. Right now, I have support behind me. And for example, my mother, being a bit old, you know they say "old school" in our [Country]. That's how it is. So, whenever you try to take a step forward, "oh my son, don't do it like this," "oh my son, don't do it like that." You know mothers, our mothers are unconventional. They always think of the negative side. They see the glass half empty. Right now, for example, we're going to buy a car. We don't have savings, we don't have this. I discussed it with my spouse. She said "We'll make it work, we'll do it together. Let's hit the road, we'll do it". She supported me in this. And we're on this path now. God willing, in [1-5] month, we'll own a car. If I didn't have my spouse, if I were to say in my bachelor pad, "Mom, I'm going to buy a car," she'd say, "Son, you don't have the money. It's not like this or that," and it would end there. Like I said, her support means a lot. That's how it's going.

Interviewer: So, has this relationship changed you?

Speaker: Yes.

Interviewer: How has it changed you?

Speaker: There are positive and negative aspects. Well, as things.

Interviewer: I'd love to hear both.

Speaker: Alright. For example, positively, my life has become more organized. I was very comfortable when I was single. You know, carefree. They say "Does a bachelor have any worries?" I was comfortable in that sense. I could spend money without thinking much. And I didn't know I had attention deficit hyperactivity disorder. I didn't do any research on that. I never thought about it. After we got married, my spouse read books to understand me. And then she said, "You might have this problem." We started getting professional help from a psychologist about this. As I said, in good ways, such things can happen. Spouses can support each other and do such things. But from the bad side, I can't spend time on myself. I come home exhausted from work. My only thought is to lie down and watch a movie and fall asleep, or to spend some time. But you're married, you know. Your spouse expects something from you. There are chores to do at home. If there are children, it's even harder. So, that's bad.

Interviewer: Do you think your spouse has changed during the relationship?

Speaker: She has changed.

Interviewer: How do you think she has changed?

Speaker: She's the same, I think she has both perfect and good and bad sides. My wife, like I said, I don't know much about her youth before I met her. But after we got married, although it wasn't very good, we occasionally have this problem: She says, "I wish I hadn't married, this is how I would be." But I don't know now. If you ask my wife about this, it would be more appropriate.

Interviewer: Actually, I'm going to ask a different kind of question. Do you think the person you were before the relationship and the person you are now are the same?

Speaker: No. Completely different.

Interviewer: How are these two [Name] different?

Speaker: Let me put it this way. At that time I was an [16-20] year old [Name]. It's been [1-5] years since I got married. Now I'm [31-35]-[36-40] years old and I have the structure to think like an adult. Like I said, I could directly go and buy what I wanted. There was no thinking. Now I'm married at home. I have children, I have a family. I have to support a house. When taking a step, I should think whether will I be able to do it tomorrow? Will I be able to pay for it? There is a thought. It was like a mature thought, I mean an adult thought.

Interviewer: So if I were to ask the same question about your wife, do you think your marriage or relationship with her has changed since the beginning? Or do you think she is the same?

Speaker: I would think it's different. I think she would say it, but...

Interviewer: How do you think about it? How has she changed over time in your marriage?

Speaker: In marriage... Let me tell you about our relationship right now. My expectations were very high. You know, imagining that we'd be happy like this, like that. Unfortunately, it's not like that. It doesn't always end happily ever after like in movies. There are difficulties in life. Sometimes parties can be hurtful in response to the answers to those difficulties. Or sometimes even more. For example, my wife says to me, you know, we're having a problem, for example. She says, "You're not doing anything, you're not worried, you're not taking it seriously." I say, "It's a simple thing, don't stress so much." But my wife stresses as if there's death at the end. We have such problems. So, as I said, without mutual understanding and love, it doesn't work like this.

Interviewer: Do you feel safe in this relationship?

Speaker: Yes.

Interviewer: Could you elaborate on why you said that?

Speaker: What exactly do you mean by "safe"?

Interviewer: Generally speaking. Physically, emotionally. What does safety mean to you, in a relationship or in any situation? I'm curious about that.

Speaker: Let me tell you about my elders in the family. For instance, when I first got married, my beloved elders told me something like, "marriage begins when the lights go out at home." This isn't about sexuality, don't misunderstand. If you turn off the lights, if you're happy with your spouse, you cuddle and share your secrets. For example "I did that, telling each other our problems like this and that". My mother lives with us. When we turn off the light in the bedroom, my spouse starts, "your mother did this and that to me. Here are my problems." She tells me without offending my mother or me. Or I tell my spouse the same way. There's trust. Or I can tell my spouse a secret very comfortably. I know she won't go somewhere and tell others, won't say anything, won't make fun of me, won't just laugh, will try to solve the problem. I can tell her everything. I can not tell completely and clearly. I'm sorry, I'm a little excited.

Interviewer: No, it's okay, there's no problem. Sometimes we think of questions for the first time. So I really understand.

Speaker: Yes.

Interviewer: Actually, could you give a little more example about safe and unsafety? Thank you very much for what you've given. But could you open those concepts a little more, I would be very happy. Can you give an example from your relationship?

Speaker: I understand, I understand. Safety, as I said, there is a mutual thing. A person's most vulnerable state is the sleep state, from my point of view. I can lie on my back and turn inward. Because I know she won't stab me in the back. She won't hurt me spiritually or physically. And I will say I am in safe, and I turn my back and sleep. Or my spouse, too, in the same way with me. If there was no safety, I would have thought, "what will she do at night, will she stab me, hit me, kill me? Will she leave me? Or after I sleep, will she betray me?" There are no thoughts like these. When you trust.

Interviewer: You also see the remaining time above. Let me stop my words, I really don't want to. If you wish, let's stop this recording here. Let's continue with a link again. I'll send it again anyway. Thank you very much. For now, I'm stopping this recording.

PART 2

Interviewer: Hello again. I want to visualize my next question a bit. I'll share my screen. Just a moment. Can you see my screen now?

Speaker: Yes.

Interviewer: If I asked, "My partner generally listens to me," where would you place your answer on a scale of one to nine, with one being not at all true and nine being completely true?

Speaker: Seven.

Interviewer: What about, "My partner is generally sensitive to my needs?"

Speaker: My partner is sensitive to my needs... I'd say seven for that too.

Interviewer: Okay, thank you very much. I'll stop the screen share. You answered seven for the question, "My partner generally listens to me." Why did you choose seven?

Speaker: My wife really listens to me. But if something doesn't make sense to her, she comments without fully understanding, asking why it's necessary. She listens, tries to understand, but doesn't fully comprehend. So, she doesn't listen with full understanding.

Interviewer: Can you give more concrete examples of when this happens?

Speaker: For example, we're planning to buy a car in a few months. Our budget is for a 200-300 thousand lira car, but decent cars in that range don't exist anymore. I suggested taking a loan and buying a more expensive car. Initially, she was skeptical, questioning how we'd pay for it. Eventually, she agreed after we visited places like [Location] and [Location], realizing we could buy a car with easy monthly payments. But initially, she didn't fully understand my suggestion.

Interviewer: Why did you choose seven and not six or eight?

Speaker: If she had fully understood, she would have gotten my point. But she answered based on her understanding. So, she didn't fully engage with the topic. But she did listen and we discussed it, which is why it's not lower than six. Seven is fair.

Interviewer: You also rated, "My partner is generally sensitive to my needs," as seven. Why did you choose seven?

Speaker: She generally fulfills 99% of my needs. For instance, she knows exactly what kind of pants I like and buys them as a surprise. However, she often says no to things I'm interested in, like electronics. I wanted to try a drone for fun, but she dismissed it as unnecessary.

Interviewer: Why did you choose seven instead of six or eight?

Speaker: I deducted one point because she often says no. For example, she doesn't understand my interest in electronics and stops me from buying things. That's why it's seven.

Interviewer: I hope it's okay to ask my next question. If not, please feel free to decline. But if you're comfortable, I'd like to know about your physical intimacy as a couple. How often do you have sexual relations these days?

Speaker: We've had a problem since we got married... [redacted].

Interviewer: That's why we mention it beforehand, in case you're comfortable answering.

Speaker: Normally, I wouldn't answer either. But we've seen many psychologists, and I've realized I'm more comfortable talking about it. I grew up in a small place, so I've become more open about it. The issue isn't just mine, so it's important to describe it accurately to get proper help. So, I'm comfortable answering this question.

Interviewer: Thank you for sharing. If you're comfortable, I'd also like to ask how satisfied you are with your sexual life.

Speaker: I'm not satisfied.

Interviewer: Can you elaborate on why you feel this way?

Speaker: As I mentioned, we've seen many psychologists. My wife would initially be motivated, but after the first session, she wouldn't want to continue. We've seen multiple doctors with the same result. She even suggested I divorce her to find someone else, but I reassured her. We've mostly resolved the issue now.

Interviewer: Thank you for sharing. I know it's a sensitive topic. I'll share my screen again to visualize the next question. How satisfied are you with your relationship overall?

Speaker: I'd say very satisfied, but not completely. So, satisfied.

Interviewer: If you were to rate your satisfaction on a scale of one to ten, what would you choose?

Speaker: Eight.

Interviewer: Why did you choose eight?

Speaker: We still have issues, especially regarding sexual problems and disagreements during discussions. These are things that bring the score down. But in other areas, she's wonderful. She's great with cooking, cleaning, and supporting me and our children. That's why it's an eight.

Interviewer: We're almost done. I want to summarize what we've discussed over the past two hours to see if there's anything you'd like to add or correct. You mentioned you met your wife at work and felt an instant connection, like aşk at first sight. You started dating after going out together a few times. You believe that respect, love, and loyalty are the qualities of a high-quality relationship, while disrespect, disorder, and conflicts over differences make it low-quality. You said the most important things in a good relationship are love, respect, and understanding. You defined aşk as your heart trembling when you make eye contact and said it's important in a relationship. Your partner shows her love through care, sacrifice, and support. You sometimes argue, but resolve conflicts through communication. Besides communication, you believe financial matters are also important in today's relationships. This relationship has changed both of you positively. These were my notes. Is there anything you'd like to add or correct?

Speaker: Your notes are correct. I have nothing to add.

Interviewer: Lastly, did your relationship meet your expectations?

Speaker: If I were to rate it out of ten, I'd say it met nine of my expectations.

Interviewer: Can you elaborate on what was met and what wasn't?

Speaker: My childhood was difficult; I lost my father at [1-5]. My mother raised us with a lot of discipline and caution about money. This caused me to feel regretful about things I couldn't have. When I became financially independent, I spent freely. My wife doesn't fully understand this. I sometimes buy toys for my son to fulfill my childhood desires. This causes disagreements between us.

Interviewer: Thank you again. I have one last question. How comfortable did you feel answering these questions?

Speaker: I felt very comfortable. It was like therapy for me.

Interviewer: I'm glad to hear that. Thank you very much. Before we finish, we want to be transparent about how we handle the data. We have two options for sharing. The first is to share parts of the transcript without any identifying information. The second is to share the entire anonymized transcript. Which do you prefer?

Speaker: I'm comfortable with the second option since no one around me is interested in psychology.

Interviewer: Thank you very much.

Speaker: You're welcome.

Interviewer: This study is also being conducted in the Philippines, Brazil, the Netherlands, France, and the USA. We need to reach a diverse range of participants. If it's okay with you, can you suggest two people who might be interested in this study?

Speaker: Do they have to be married or can they be in a relationship?

Interviewer: Any form of relationship is fine. If that's okay with you, I'll stop the recording.

Speaker: That's fine.

Interviewer: Okay.